

people and you get to figure out certain aspects of compatibility that you didn't know you needed before. The advantage is that on a dating website you're not turning people down from marriage, like on a matrimonial site, instead, you're just moving on to the next date, but the learnings can sharpen the picture you have in your head of the perfect life partner.

THE PERFECT MATCH

Machine learning-based algorithms that work on big data are amazing. From global market trades to security surveillance, algorithms pretty much rule the world. They see the bigger picture on a level no human even can, and have the ability to evolve according to the needs of their creators. Take for example, the algorithms behind Spotify's suggestions, or Facebook's News Feed, keeping a billion plus people hooked, day in and day out, working silently and effectively. Algorithms are invading every aspect of our lives, and with good reason. But while machines are great at matching you to a product, story, picture, etc., matching people is still something they haven't cracked just yet.

Online dating sites don't claim that their match-making algorithms are just an *alternate* way to meeting people, they claim it's a *better* way. Now this might be true for people who have, say, moved to a new city and don't have too many friends or an established work/friends circle. It's probably also true for people who are a little shy, or introverted, or suffers from social anxiety, because it gives them the ability to converse online instead of in person, at least initially. But how can a data query know what issues will rise between people in the future, how they will confront them, and how they will mature and grow? While the collaborative filtering method and other machine learning algorithms have their merits, technology cannot predict the future of people the way it can predict numbers. Besides, there are a host of collectively unanswerable questions about human relationships – do opposites really attract, or do people need to be similar? If they are too similar, won't they get bored? If they are too different, where is their common ground? It is all very confusing and there are no right answers. Perhaps

your best bet is to meet people while doing something you love. Chances are much higher that you will share a longer and more fulfilling journey through life with someone who you have an activity in common with.



If only finding love were that easy

As much as we'd like to believe that technology already has the answers for most things, we haven't been able to break down a human into math just yet. How do we know this? Because if we could do that, we'd already have AI, and we don't. The day we can fall in love with Siri or Cortana, or some other artificial consciousness (we, as in normal people, not the crazies who might already have fallen for them), that's the day we might be able to build a case for machines truly understanding what it is to be human. Maybe then an AI algorithm would be able to act like your friends who know you well, and recommend you meet this person who they are sure you will hit it off with.

Until then, rest assured that you're going to have to do all of the decision making yourself, and you're going to have to do some real work before you find love. At best, apps and algorithms can help you weed out the most obvious incompatibilities, which is still better than nothing!

Just remember, you could find love just about anywhere... online, on OkCupid or Shaadi.com, Quora or 9gag, Facebook or Twitter, at a work conference, or in a line to buy food, or, our favourite, at a bookstore, while buying your favourite computer magazine. "You love Digit too?", has got to be the best ice breaker we've ever heard! 

WANKBAND

Mankind has been trying to extract renewable energy from every source it can find. The wind, tides, sun, dams... you name it. However, this one might be the most ingenious of all! The aptly named WankBand contains a kinetic charger which is designed to generate energy when your wrist moves up and down. Conceptualised by none other than Pornhub, the creators are only too happy to give you incentive to use this gadget. As they put it, the idea is to love the planet while loving yourself!

Think about all of those teenagers (at heart) furiously charging their WankBands to help power up their smartphones, which will be then be drained of battery power as they playback material that will help them power the band. The circle of energy will finally be complete, and we will finally have found a way to put a teenager's excessive energy to good use.

We all have that friend who could probably live off the grid based on how much power we imagine him creating with a device like this. You thought of him just now, didn't you? Let's just hope the batteries used in it aren't the same as the Note 7!



The world energy crisis is over